

Heartsbreath Test for Heart Transplant Rejection

260.10 Links in PDF documents are not guaranteed to work. To follow a web link, please use the MCD Website.

Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

260.10

Manual Section Title

Heartsbreath Test for Heart Transplant Rejection

Version Number

1

Effective Date of this Version

12/08/2008

Implementation Date

04/06/2009

Description Information

Benefit Category

Diagnostic Tests (other)

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Item/Service Description

A. General

The Heartsbreath test is a Food and Drug Administration-approved Humanitarian Use Device for use only as an adjunct to the endomyocardial biopsy to detect grade 3 heart transplant rejection in patients who have had a heart transplant within the last year and an endomyocardial biopsy within the prior month. The test involves collecting breath samples from the patient and analysis of the samples performed in a laboratory. These test results are then compared to endomyocardial biopsy findings and the results are provided to the clinician shortly thereafter.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

B. Nationally Covered Indications

N/A

C. Nationally Non-Covered Indications

Effective for services performed on or after December 8, 2008, the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services has determined that the evidence does not adequately define the technical characteristics of the test nor demonstrate that Heartsbreath testing to predict heart transplant rejection improves health outcomes in Medicare beneficiaries. Thus, we conclude that the Heartsbreath test is not reasonable and necessary under section 1862(a)(1)(A) of the Social Security Act and is non-covered.

D. Other

N/A

(This NCD last reviewed December 2008.)

Claims Processing Instructions

[TN 1683 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

[TN 1697 \(Medicare Claims Processing\)](#) 

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

99

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R99NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

02/2009 - CMS determines that the evidence does not adequately define the technical characteristics of the test nor demonstrate that Heartsbreath testing to predict heart transplant rejection improves health outcomes in Medicare beneficiaries. Thus, we conclude that the Heartsbreath Test is not reasonable and necessary under section 1862(a)(1)(A) of the Social Security Act, and is non-covered. Effective Date: 12/08/2008 Implementation Date: 04/06/2009 ([TN 99](#) ) (CR6366).

National Coverage Analyses (NCAs)

This NCD has been or is currently being reviewed under the National Coverage Determination process. The following are existing associations with NCAs, from the National Coverage Analyses database.

- [Original Consideration for Heartsbreath Test for Heart Transplant Rejection \(CAG-00394N\)](#) 

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Heartsbreath Test for Heart Transplant Rejection	1	12/08/2008 - N/A	You are here